A Cape for the Case

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 4

The glass case rested beneath the stopping-place roof. Nib wrapped a spare cover around it until even the handle disappeared. It was beautifully covered and impossible to carry. Rain brushed the roof edge while Lark laid the guide open where it stayed dry.

“A cape of considerable elegance,” Nib declared. “A handle of considerable usefulness,” Lark observed warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **van**

“Compare cap and cape,” Lark modeled clearly. “In cape, a and the final silent e work across the middle consonant to give a its long sound. Tap becomes tape the same way. The little word a is special: here we say it softly, /uh/, before a name for something. We'll learn that word explicitly, too.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cape, tape, make, a. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tape on the fitting note,” Lark invited gently. “Where does the diagram leave room for the handle?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can make a cape. Pat can tape it.**

“What can Pat do after Sam makes the cape?” Lark asked warmly. “Use the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib opened the unnecessary top fold. Lark held a fitted cloth cape around the case while he fixed its lower edge with tape. The rain could run off, and the handle stayed free. They tested a short lift before returning the covered case to its padded place. At the narrow approach ahead, a short stopping note waited.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cape beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The journal picture showed both the dry case and its usable handle. Nib carried the light guide while the van brought the covered glass onward. The next support was visible, but not ready to cross.